

India's GDP growth in FY24 to be higher than FY23. "ICRA expects India's GDP growth to ease to 6 per cent in FY24 from the 6.9 per cent expected in FY23, owing to the expected drag from exports amid slowing global growth, as well as normalising base," says Nayar. Adds Joshi of CRISIL: "We expect gross domestic product growth to slow to 6 per cent this fiscal from 7 per cent last fiscal as slowing global growth, domestic interest rates, and messy geopolitics bite."

A BELOW NORMAL MONSOON AMID FEARS OF AN EL NIÑO EFFECT COULD SHAVE OFF UP TO 50 BPS FROM GDP GROWTH, SAY EXPERTS

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Is there any good news to look forward to? Roy feels India has some inherent strengths, including the China+1 policy benefitting certain pockets of manufacturing, trade agreement discussions improving certain export prospects, and the services sector growing. Nayar adds: "We expect consumer sentiment to improve in FY24, auguring well for consumption demand, although it would remain uneven." She also expects the sizeable expansion in the budgeted capital spending by the Union government and several state governments to provide support to economic activity, amid signs of an uptick in private capex, "although execution remains key".

Some consolation there? Well, go figure. **BT**

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Running Short

Data clearly shows that filling up vacancies at the Securities Appellate Tribunal has not always been high on the government's priority list; currently it is one member short

BY ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

► **THE DAY WAS** February 29, 2016. Then Finance Minister Arun Jaitley rose to deliver the Budget speech. As he reached the part focussed on financial sector reforms, he touched upon the subject of the Securities Appellate Tribunal (SAT)—the tribunal that has been set up to hear appeals against orders passed by key regulatory bodies like the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi), Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) and the Pension Fund Regulatory

and Development Authority (PFRDA).

"I also propose to amend the Sebi Act, 1992, in the coming year to provide for more members and benches of the Securities Appellate Tribunal," said the late Jaitley who was finance minister from 2014 to 2019.

More than seven years have passed since the statement was made but till date no progress has been made on the announcement. There is just one bench of SAT in Mumbai that is manned by a presiding officer—a retired judge—and